

Whose Goal Is It?



BIG IDEA Platforms are designed by people with goals, and one common goal is holding your attention. When you can name a design feature, whose goal it serves and what you can do about it, you choose your own settings.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

REVIEW STATUS Educator review before use. A teacher or counselor should read this once. Statements about how platforms earn money or affect people are marked [VERIFY]; cite a primary source before using any statistic.

COUNSELOR HEADS-UP FIRST + OPT-OUT PLAN A counselor heads-up is recommended: students may disclose compulsive use or low mood. No opt-out is expected; the alternate is “My Autonomy Settings,” done individually. District policy governs [VERIFY].

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Say: “Hackles up? When an app keeps pulling you back, or shows you more and more of the same, notice who is steering. Every feed you use was built by a team with goals, and one goal is often to keep you there. That is a business model. Florida’s law on social media accounts for minors lists some ‘addictive features’: infinite scrolling, push notifications, personal interactive metrics, auto-play video and live-streaming. Today we study those features, who they serve, and how you stay in control.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Feature X-Ray and Feed Sorter*

- 1 (1 min) Persuasive design** means choices made to change what people do. Not all of it is bad: a medication reminder is persuasive. Ask: whose goal, and do you know it?
- 2 (4 min) Feature X-Ray in groups.** For each LoopFeed card: What it does. What it wants me to do. Who benefits. My counter-move. Example: infinite scroll removes the stopping point and the platform gains your time; counter-move: a timer or stopping rule. “For You” learns what you react to; counter-move: curate who you follow, search on purpose. The class covers all seven.
- 3 (2 min) Feed Sorter in pairs.** Round 1: six posts; mark the two you would “like.” Round 2: LoopFeed “deals” five more, three from the theme you liked most. “What happened to variety? Who chose?”
- 4 (1 min) My Autonomy Settings.** Two settings to change this week (one notification class off, a daily time limit, “following” instead of “for you”) and the Defense Plan line.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Which feature was hardest to see as designed? Why?”
- 2** “What is the difference between a design that helps you and one that holds you?”
- 3** “What would you ask a company to change? What can you change yourself?”

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: RP3 LoopFeed Feature Cards (seven per group), Feature X-Ray sheet (W-P3), Feed Sorter deck (fifteen fictional posts, two rounds), My Autonomy Settings card. LoopFeed is a made-up app.

- ☐ Print seven Feature Cards per group and the Feed Sorter decks.
- ☐ Show no real brands or screenshots.

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Pause when you notice the pull. Check which feature is steering and whose goal it serves. Tell a friend or trusted adult if an app is making you feel worse or you cannot cut down. It is never your fault that feeds are built to hold attention. You can still choose your settings.”

Hand signal: Hackles up (hand brushed up the neck, optional). Post it: “Whose goal is it? Then choose your setting.”

EXIT TICKET “Name one design feature, say whose goal it serves, and write one counter-move.”

FUN BOOST Redesign Sprint. Groups get three minutes to redesign one LoopFeed feature so it is easier to put down. Vote by hands.

LEVEL-UP Autonomy by design. One page for LoopFeed: two features, a reason for each change.

DIFFERENTIATE Use four Feature Cards with sentence frames.

FAMILY CARD Ask: “Which of these pulls on you most? What setting could we change together?” If your teen seems low or anxious, the counselor can help.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You are not in trouble.”
- “Let’s get you support.”
- “I can’t keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who.”
- **Do not say:** “You’re addicted.” Do not diagnose.
- “Just stop.”
- “I won’t tell anyone.”

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: self-harm or hopelessness: district protocol and 988. Tell your counselor or designated person the same day; follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law (abuse: Florida Abuse Hotline 1-800-962-2873).